Somerset LANGUAGE CENTRE

SOMERSET LANGUAGE CENTRE · B2-LEVEL EXAM PRACTICE · CAMBRIDGE FORMAT

Listening

Candidate Name

Candidate Number

Centre

Date

TIME ALLOWED

approx. 40 minutes

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

- This paper contains four parts. You will hear each recording twice.
- Write your answers on the question paper.
- You will have time to check your answers at the end of the test.

INFORMATION FOR CANDIDATES

PART	QUESTIONS
Part 1	1–8
Part 2	9–18
Part 3	19–23
Part 4	24–30

DRAFT — NOT FOR LIVE USE

Original Somerset content (GEN01), Cambridge B2-level format, laid out to match Somerset's own reference practice paper. Every objectively-scored part has passed a blind-solve check, but no teacher has reviewed this paper end to end yet. Do not administer this to a student until Hugo or Sara has read it in full.

AUDIO NOT YET RECORDED

This is a print preview of the Listening question paper only. No audio track exists for GEN01 yet, so this paper cannot be sat as a real listening test. Once audio is generated and reviewed, this file becomes the student question paper to use alongside it. Until then, see the separate Teacher Audioscript for read-aloud piloting.

Part 1

You will hear people talking in eight different situations. For questions 1–8, choose the best answer (A, B or C). You will hear each recording twice.

1 You hear a woman talking about a course she took.

What does the speaker say about the pottery course?

A A family member encouraged her to try it.

B She found it easy from the very first lesson.

C She has decided not to continue with it.

2 You hear a man talking about moving house.

How did the speaker find the flat he eventually bought?

A He had been searching for it online for months.

B A colleague told him about it.

C He saw it advertised in a local shop window.

3 You hear a teenager talking about a school trip.

What does the speaker say about the school trip?

A He had never visited the museum before.

B His enthusiasm grew once he was there.

C He was disappointed by the exhibition.

4 You hear a woman talking about her job.

What does the speaker say about her career change?

A She regrets the drop in income.

B She still finds the job exhausting.

C She prioritised job satisfaction over salary.

5 You hear a man talking about a sports injury.

What does the speaker say about his recovery?

A He is following his physio's advice despite his impatience.

B He returned to playing sooner than the physio recommended.

C He disagreed with the physio's assessment of his injury.

6 You hear a woman talking about learning a language.

What has the speaker decided to do about her Portuguese?

A Spend more time using the language app.

B Stop learning the language for now.

C Start attending a class with other people.

7 You hear a man talking about a restaurant.

What does the speaker say about the restaurant?

A The food did not live up to his expectations.

B He would avoid returning because of the slow service.

C The meal took much longer than he had planned.

8 You hear a woman talking about volunteering.

What does the speaker say surprised her most about volunteering?

A How much she enjoyed being around animals.

B How close she became to the other volunteers.

C How long she has continued doing it.

Part 2

You will hear a man called Dan giving a talk about a photography club. For questions 9–18, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

Riverside Photography Club

(9) The club was founded in ___ .

(10) The club does not meet during the month of ___ .

(11) This term the club is focusing mainly on ___ photography.

(12) The first four weeks of term will cover ___ .

(13) Students who don't bring a camera can ___ one for the evening.

(14) Full membership for the term costs £ ___ .

(15) The first field trip this term will be to ___ .

(16) Everyone must hand in a completed ___ by next Tuesday.

(17) The club's online group is run through an app called ___ .

(18) Tonight's session will focus on the camera's ___ settings.

Part 3

You will hear five short extracts in which people talk about starting their own business. For questions 19–23, choose from the list (A–H) what each speaker says. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

A They received unexpected financial help.

B They underestimated how much time it would take.

C They were motivated by a negative experience at work.

D They regret not starting sooner.

E Their family were unsupportive of the decision.

F They had no relevant experience in the field.

G They found the paperwork more difficult than expected.

H A friend became their business partner.

Speaker 1 **19** ☐

Speaker 2 **20** ☐

Speaker 3 **21** ☐

Speaker 4 **22** ☐

Speaker 5 **23** ☐

Part 4

You will hear an interview with a wildlife photographer called Claire Byrne. For questions 24–30, choose the best answer (A, B or C).

24 Why did Claire start photographing urban wildlife?

A She had deliberately planned the project for years.

B An unplanned delay in London led her to notice foxes nearby.

C A publisher specifically commissioned the project.

25 What does Claire say about photographing animals in cities compared to somewhere like the Amazon?

A It required less patience than she expected.

B It was more physically demanding overall.

C It was harder in ways people don't expect.

26 How does Claire feel about the photograph of the fox family?

A It is her proudest image, but not her personal favourite.

B It is both her proudest and her favourite image.

C She now regrets including it in the book.

27 What does Claire's favourite photograph in the book show?

A A dramatic scene of foxes at night.

B A heron standing still on a rooftop.

C A busy street full of urban wildlife.

28 What message does Claire want the project to communicate?

A Wildlife photography requires travelling to remote places.

B Wildlife exists close to us if we look for it.

C Urban animals are becoming increasingly rare.

29 What advice does Claire give to people starting out in wildlife photography?

A Invest in the best equipment available before beginning.

B Focus on spending time outdoors observing animals.

C Avoid urban locations until gaining more experience.

30 What does Claire say about her future plans?

A She has a confirmed project starting in Spain.

B She intends to keep working without a break.

C She has an unconfirmed idea for a project near Valencia.